

Fourth Suit Forcing New Minor Forcing Help Suit Game Try

FSF : Suppose the partnership has already mentioned three suits, and the player who is next to bid wants to make a forcing bid but has no bid that is really descriptive of his hand. He just bids the fourth suit (whether he has it or not). This asks partner to further describe her hand.

NMF : Similar to FSF, this is Responder's second bid after she makes a suit response to partner's suit opening and Opener then bids Notrump. Bidding a previously unbid (New) minor suit asks for further description.

HSGT : When the bidding starts 1Major - 2Major, Opener can invite to game by bidding 3Major. A more descriptive invitation is to bid a different suit; this is also an invitation to game but asks partner to pay particular attention to whether he can "Help" in that suit.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these three conventions.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣10

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠2

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: South
Lead: ♦4

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: West
Lead: ♥Q

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠K

Board: 6
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♣6

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10 6
♥ 7
♦ K 10 3 2
♣ A 8 7 6 3

♠ A J
♥ K Q J 8 4
♦ A 5
♣ J 5 4 2



♠ 9 8 7 4 2
♥ A 6 2
♦ Q J 7
♣ 10 9

♠ K 5 3
♥ 10 9 5 3
♦ 9 8 6 4
♣ K Q

NORTH cannot see a game unless SOUTH has help in ♣s so she makes a Help Suit Game Try.

SOUTH has 8 points and the doubleton ♣ K Q so he bids the game.

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	3 ♣	Pass	4 ♥
All Pass			
4 ♥ by North			
Lead: ♣ 10			

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 9 8 5
 ♥ J 7 4
 ♦ K Q 10 3
 ♣ A K 5

♠ K 6 4
 ♥ K 9 6 5
 ♦ J 5
 ♣ 9 7 3 2

	N	
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♠ A J 10
 ♥ A Q 10 3
 ♦ 9 4
 ♣ Q J 6 4

♠ Q 7 3 2
 ♥ 8 2
 ♦ A 8 7 6 2
 ♣ 10 8

WEST has a perfect hand on which to use Fourth Suit Forcing. If East can stop ♠s, then 3NT would be a great contract.

There is one problem - if WEST bids 1♠ at her second turn it is NOT considered FSF, so she must jump to 2♠.

EAST, win a fine ♠ stopper, bids 3NT.

West	North	East	South
		1♣	Pass
1♦	Pass	1♥	Pass
2♠	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			
3NT by East			
Lead: ♠2			

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 9 6
 ♥ A 5 4 2
 ♦ 9 6 4
 ♣ 8 4 2

♠ K 8 4 3 2

♥ K Q 8 3

♦ 7 3

♣ A 5



♠ J 10

♥ 9

♦ K Q J 10 5 2

♣ 10 9 7 6

♠ Q 7 5

♥ J 10 7 6

♦ A 8

♣ K Q J 3

NORTH's 2♦ bid is a perfect example of NMF. It provides SOUTH with the opportunity to show either a 4-card ♥ suit, OR 3-card ♠ support.

In this hand SOUTH actually has both. When that happens, showing the ♥s is first priority.

West	North	East	South
			1♣
Pass	1♠	Pass	1NT
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			
4♥ by South			
Lead: ♦4			

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ K J 9 7

♥ 8 7

♦ A K J 6 2

♣ 10 2

♠ 6 5 2

♥ Q J 10 3

♦ Q 7

♣ K 7 6 3



♠ Q 10 8 3

♥ A K 6 5

♦ 10

♣ A 9 8 4

♠ A 4

♥ 9 4 2

♦ 9 8 5 4 3

♣ Q J 5

WEST's 1♠ bid is definitely forcing, but it is not FSF. In this one instance, all bids at the one level, the ♠ bid shows a real suit.

So EAST shows the 4-card support and WEST bids game.

*West**North**East**South*

1♦

Pass

1♣

Pass

1♠

Pass

1♥

Pass

4♠

Pass

2♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by West

Lead: ♥Q

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 5 3 2

♥ J 8

♦ A K 9 6 4 2

♣ 3

♠ A 6 4

♥ A K 9 7 2

♦ 7

♣ K 8 6 5



♠ K Q J 10

♥ 10 4

♦ Q J 5

♣ Q 10 9 4

♠ 9 7

♥ Q 6 5 3

♦ 10 8 3

♣ A J 7 2

NORTH could make a Help Suit Game Try in either ♠s or ♣s. But she doesn't need the ♠ help as much as she does in ♣s, so she chooses ♣s.

SOUTH doesn't have a strong hand but has excellent help in ♣s so he bids the game.

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♥

Pass

2 ♥

Pass

3 ♣

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by North

Lead: ♠ K

Board 6

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K J 10 5

♥ 10 9 6

♦ K 7

♣ A Q J 3

♠ 4 3

♥ A 4 2

♦ Q J 10 6 3

♣ 10 7 4



♠ Q 6

♥ K J 8 5

♦ A 9 8 5 4

♣ K 8

♠ A 9 8 7 2

♥ Q 7 3

♦ 2

♣ 9 6 5 2

Could EAST bid 2♥, (FSF), even though she actually has the suit?

Perhaps, but there is no reason to do so. WEST does not have four ♥s or he would have mentioned them before bidding ♠s.

EAST should ignore the ♥ suit and bid 3NT.

West

1♣

1♠

All Pass

3NT by East

Lead: ♣6

North

Pass

Pass

East

1♦

3NT

South

Pass